



OUT OF HELLFIRE

A Dungeons & Dragons 5e adventure

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Out of Hellfire

pulp adventure, '80s camp

D&D 5e (2014)

Level 3

Duration: one-shot (1-2 sessions)

Structure: linear

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△ Auto-translated from Italian. The Italian version is the source of truth.

Out of Hellfire

Lore

Greyhawkins is a port city where the bizarre is the norm — but nobody expected what happened at the Oakshore docks. A series of murders, corrupted rats everywhere, and behind it all an elf with a too-wide smile and a melody that got inside your head:

Korex.

The party unmasked him, defeated his rats, and put him to flight. Korex escaped into the sewers beneath the docks — sewers nobody knew existed. The Oakshore Guard doesn't have the resources to pursue him underground. It's up to the party.

Introduction

The rain beats down on the Oakshore docks. Sheriff Udo Hutchinson looks at you with a mix of gratitude and impatience. "He escaped into the sewers. The old ones, under the east pier — we didn't even know they were still open." He checks the sword at his hip. "I'm coming with you. Bring him up. Alive or dead, I don't care. Just make sure he doesn't come back."

The PCs have just finished the fight with the rats. Korex fled through a grate in the floor of the warehouse at the docks. Udo, having just returned to Oakshore from a personal trip, found the district in chaos and has no intention of sending people into the sewers without going himself.

General Plot

- **Act 1 — The Descent:** the PCs enter the sewers pursuing Korex. Dark tunnels, traps left by Korex to slow them down, servants left behind to cover his escape. The environment becomes progressively stranger — the sewers are older and larger than they should be.
- **Act 2 — The Lair:** the PCs reach Korex's hideout. Final confrontation with the bard and his last defenders. Korex can be captured alive (if the PCs resist the charm) or killed.

- **Act 3 — The Discovery:** with the Korex matter resolved, the PCs find the Anello del Virtuoso on his finger — a cursed artifact containing the soul of an ancient bard. Whoever touches it risks putting it on. Whoever wears it gains power, but begins to be possessed. If no PC touches it, a guard puts it on and the problem explodes anyway.

DM Tips

- **Tone:** maintain the camp from the starter kit. Korex is theatrical, the rats are grotesque, the sewers are over-the-top. But the final cliffhanger must have a shift in register — the moment when the comedy stops and the players realize there's something serious going on.
- **Korex in combat:** he doesn't fight fair. He charms, runs, sends servants ahead. If cornered, he begs for mercy — and lies.
- **Capture vs kill:** both options are valid. If captured alive, Korex can provide information (a mix of truth and lies). If killed, the information can be found in his notes in the lair.
- **The cliffhanger:** after the milestone, the Anello del Virtuoso comes into play. The ring was on Korex's finger — it's the source of his power. It contains the soul of an ancient bard who wants to return to life. Three-tier mechanic: passive attraction → touch (WIS save DC 20 or forced wearing) → progressive possession. If no PC touches it, an NPC guard puts it on and attacks. Details in `DiscussioneNarrativa.md`.

Recommended difficulty: 3 PCs at level 3 + Udo Hutchinson + Fin Ditasvelte (NPC companion) **Scalability:** for 4+ PCs, Udo stays behind to watch the entrance and Fin doesn't join (the charm hasn't broken yet). For 2 PCs, keep both companions.

Main NPCs

Full sheets in `characters/`.

- **Udo Hutchinson** — sheriff of Oakshore, veteran. Joins the PCs at the sewer entrance. Party tank.
- **Korex** — CE elf bard, antagonist. Musical charmer, manipulator, coward.
- **Fin Ditasvelte** — CN halfling rogue, formerly charmed by Korex. Emerges from the sewer confused and furious, joins the PCs for revenge. Ring bearer (scenario B).
- **Jason Accordion** — TN human bard, soul within the Anello del Virtuoso. Saga villain.

Charmed thug stat block: see `MON_TeppistaCharmato.md`.

Adventure Structure

#	name	type	file
1	Descent into the Sewers	dungeon / exploration	01_DiscesaNelleFogne/ DiscesaNelleFogne.md
2	Korex's Lair	dungeon / final encounter	02_TanaDiKorex/ TanaDiKorex.md

Future Hooks

- The Anello del Virtuoso → lv4-6 saga: who was the bard in the ring? Race against time to remove it before total possession
 - Korex (if captured alive) → source of unreliable information for future adventures
 - The ancient sewers → why are they so large? Who built them? The hidden passage in the lair leads deeper
 - The bard in the ring has his own plan — he's not an ally
-

Appendix — Anello del Virtuoso Cheat Sheet

Quick reference for the DM. Full details in `NPC_JasonAccordion.md` and `DiscussioneNarrativa.md`.

Appearance: blackened silver ring, musical ouroboros engraving. It's on Korex's finger.

Activation — 3 Tiers

1. **Attraction** (passive, narrative): when Korex falls, anyone who sees the ring feels curiosity. No roll.
2. **Touch:** whoever touches the ring → WIS save DC 20. Failure = compelled to wear it. Success = manages to set it down, attraction remains.
3. **Worn:** the ring tightens, cannot be removed. Automatic attunement.

Immediate Effects

benefits	drawbacks
+2 to one ability score (by class)	The ring cannot be removed
1 bard spell 1/day without a slot	Nightmares the first night (no long rest)
Advantage on saves against charm	Constant cold in the hand
	Vulnerability to psychic damage

Possession — Grip Tracking

Each use of the 1/day spell → roll **d8**. - **2-8**: it works. - **1**: fails + psychic wave 1d4+grip to everyone within 10 ft + grip +1.

grip	narrative	mechanical
0	Cold, nightmares	Psychic vulnerability
1-2	Jason's tics, rare whispers	Wave 1d4+1/+2
3-4	Jason speaks often, foreign memories	Wave 1d4+3/+4, WIS save DC 14 under stress
5-6	Jason takes control for 1d4 rounds	Wave 1d4+5/+6, WIS save DC 15
7+	Permanent control attempt	Wave 1d4+7+, WIS save DC 16+

Reducing grip: successful WIS save vs Jason (−1), *Lesser Restoration* (−1), *Greater Restoration* (−2).

Removal

Remove Curse loosens the ring for 1d4 hours, then it returns. Permanent removal: find Jason's skeleton + burn it with salt + a wizard who knows the original ritual.

Plan A vs Plan B

- **A** (PC touches): progressive possession of the PC.
- **B variant** (Fin touches): WIS 10, Jason possesses him easily.
- **B base** (nobody touches): guard puts it on → attack → PCs defeat them → the ring remains.

“Free” = new host without defenses, not escape from the ring. Korex knew how to resist it.

Appendix — Stat Blocks

CORRUPTED RAT

Medium beast, unaligned
corrupted minion of Korex

Armor Class 12

Hit Points 7 (2d6)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses darkvision 18m / 60ft / 12qd

Challenge 1/8

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
7 (-2)	15 (+2)	11 (+0)	2 (-4)	10 (+0)	4 (-3)

Keen Smell. advantage on Perception checks that rely on smell.

Pack Tactics. advantage on attack rolls if an ally is within 1qd of the target and isn't incapacitated.

ACTIONS

Bite (melee). Attack: +4, reach 1.5m / 5ft / 1qd Damage: 1d4+2 piercing

SWARM OF RATS

Medium humanoid (swarm of tiny beasts), unaligned
Korex's minion

Armor Class 10

Hit Points 24 (7d8-7)

Speed 30 ft.

Condition Immunities charmed, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, prone, restrained, stunned

Senses darkvision 9m / 30ft / 6qd

Challenge 1/4

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
9 (-1)	11 (+0)	9 (-1)	2 (-4)	10 (+0)	3 (-4)

Keen Smell. advantage on Perception checks that rely on smell.

Swarm. can occupy another creature's space and vice versa. Can move through openings for Tiny creatures. Cannot regain HP or gain temporary HP.

ACTIONS

Bites (melee). Attack: +2, reach 0 Damage: 2d6 piercing (or 1d6 if the swarm has half HP or less)

CHARMED THUG

Medium humanoid (human), neutral (charmed, normally not hostile)

Korex's minion (charmed)

Armor Class 12 (leather armor)

Hit Points 13 (2d8+4)

Speed 30 ft.

Languages Common

Challenge 1/8

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Charmed by Korex. the thug is under the effect of charm. If Korex is killed, incapacitated, or flees, the charm breaks at the end of the round. The thug stops fighting, confused.

ACTIONS

Mace (melee). Attack: +3, reach 1.5m / 5ft / 1qd
Damage: 1d6+1 bludgeoning

FINDITASVELTE

Medium humanoid (halfling (lightfoot)), chaotic neutral
NPC party companion



Armor Class 14 (leather armor)

Hit Points 21

Speed 25 ft.

Senses none special

Languages Common, Halfling, Thieves' Cant

Challenge 2

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)

Sneak Attack (2d6). once per turn, extra damage if has advantage or ally adjacent to the target

Cunning Action. Dash, Disengage, or Hide as a bonus action

Fast Hands (Thief). Sleight of Hand, use thieves' tools, or use an object as a bonus action

Second-Story Work. climbing speed equal to movement speed

ACTIONS

Dagger (melee/ranged). Attack: +5, melee or ranged 6m / 20ft / 4qd Damage: 1d4+3 piercing Sneak Attack: +2d6 if has advantage or an ally in melee with the target

Shortbow (ranged). Attack: +5, range 24m / 80ft / 16qd Damage: 1d6+3 piercing

JASON ACCORDION

Medium humanoid (human (in life), now a trapped soul), neutral evil

saga villain — entity in the Ring of the Virtuoso



Armor Class 12

Hit Points 45 (10d8)

Speed 30 ft.

Skills Perception +2

Senses sight and hearing 36m / 120ft / 24qd (through the wearer)

Languages Common, Elvish, Sylvan, Infernal

Challenge 5

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	20 (+5)

Sentient Item. Jason exists as a soul in the Ring of the Virtuoso. He has no physical body. He communicates telepathically with the wearer. The stats above represent his mental and magical capabilities, not a body.

Spellcasting (as lv10 bard). spell save DC 16, spell attack +8. Slots: 4/3/3/3/2. Jason can only cast spells through the wearer (when he has control).

Supreme Manipulator. advantage on Deception and Persuasion checks. Creatures that speak with Jason (through the wearer) have disadvantage on saves against his charm spells.

Progressive Possession. see "Progressive possession" section above. Jason doesn't fight directly — he takes control of the wearer.

ACTIONS

Psychic Wave (when a 1 comes up on the d8). Saving throw: none (automatic) Damage: 1d4 + grip level psychic damage Area: all creatures within 15m / 50ft / 10qd of the wearer Effect: hits allies and enemies indiscriminately

KOREX

Medium humanoid (elf), chaotic evil
main antagonist



Armor Class 13

Hit Points 52

Speed 40 ft.

Skills Perception +3, Performance +4, Stealth +5

Senses darkvision

Languages Common, Elvish, sewer monster languages

Challenge 3

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+1)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	8 (-1)	12 (+1)	15 (+2)

Disengage. Korex can disengage as a bonus action

Dash. Korex can use Dash as a bonus action (doubled speed: 24m / 80ft / 16qd)

Poison Immunity. Korex is immune to the poisoned condition and poison damage

Flauto Magico. main weapon. Charm + ranged psychic damage. Devastating against targets with low Wisdom.

Rancid Knife. backup melee weapon. The poison automatically poisons on hit.

ACTIONS

Rancid Knife (melee). Attack: +5, melee Damage: 2d4+3 piercing + 2d6 poison Effect: the target is poisoned until the start of Korex's next turn

Flauto Magico (action). Target: one creature Korex can see within 36m / 120ft / 24qd Saving throw: Wisdom DC 12 Failure: 4d6 psychic damage + charmed until the start of Korex's next turn Success: half damage, no charm

Udo HUTCHINSON

Medium humanoid (human), lawful neutral
NPC party companion (sheriff of Oakshore)



Armor Class 14 (scale mail)

Hit Points 58 (9d8+18)

Speed 30 ft.

Languages Common

Challenge 3

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Udo makes two attacks with the longsword. If he has the shortsword drawn, he can make a third attack with it.

Longsword (melee). Attack: +5, reach 1.5m / 5ft / 1qd
Damage: 1d8+3 slashing (or 1d10+3 two-handed)

Shortsword (melee). Attack: +5, reach 1.5m / 5ft / 1qd
Damage: 1d6+3 piercing

Heavy Crossbow (ranged). Attack: +3, range 30/120m / 100/400ft
Damage: 1d10+1 piercing